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Editors
Environmental Monitoring and Assessment

Dear Editors,

Please consider our manuscript, "Distinguishing microplastic and oil pollutants at the water surface using multi-angle LWIR polarization imaging", as an original research article in *Environmental Monitoring and Assessment*.

The manuscript assesses a polarization contrast mechanism that may support optical monitoring of water-surface pollution. Nine plastic materials and five oils were measured with a rotating linear analyzer at five coupled illumination and observation geometries. An unpolluted water surface provided a reference. Additional measurements with the source blocked assessed the contribution of active long-wave infrared illumination.

Under the investigated laboratory conditions, the degree of linear polarization was lower for the microplastic accumulations than for the water reference and higher for the prepared oil layers. The angle of linear polarization provided weaker separation. The contribution is a controlled comparison of the two pollutant groups using the same imaging arrangement.

The study concerns prepared particle accumulations and millimeter-scale oil layers under active illumination. It does not establish detection limits for individual particles, identification of polymer or oil types, or performance in natural waters. These limits are stated in the manuscript. The work is submitted for consideration as an experimental contribution to the development of optical monitoring methods.

Thank you for considering our manuscript.

Yours sincerely,

Lukáš Krauz
Corresponding author